entities be self-created. But if we say that they are created from other things, this raises the question of what produced those producers. The rejection of real causation rules out the possibility of a final explanation.

He argues that there are no absolutes, no permanent selves, so stable entities, no intelligible distinction between agents and actions, no relations apart from things related, no intelligible distinction between past, present and future times, and no sense can be made of the idea of space.

Further reading: Garfield 1995; Murti 1955; Williams 1989

N

Nagarjuna (c. 150 CE): founder of ***Madhyamaka*** Buddhist philosophy whose most important works are the ***Mulamadhyamaka-karikas*** and *Vigrahavyavartani*. In their attempt to frame an objective and complete description of reality, Buddhist ***Abhidharma*** philosophers claimed that unobserved atomic factors (***dharmas***) are the ultimately real entities. They compiled vast catalogues of mental and material atoms, which are the building blocks of all kinds of subjects, experiences and objects. They thought that the ***dharmas*** possessed intrinsic natures or essences (***svabhava***) and that this distinguished them from the macroscopic compound entities that they make up. Nothing made of parts is ultimately real. Essence here means a nature that is unchanging, without beginning or end, self-sufficient and independent of anything else. Nagarjuna insists that the ***Abhidharma*** outlook is contrary to authentic Buddhist teaching which says that there are no unchanging essences: everything is empty (***shunya***) of